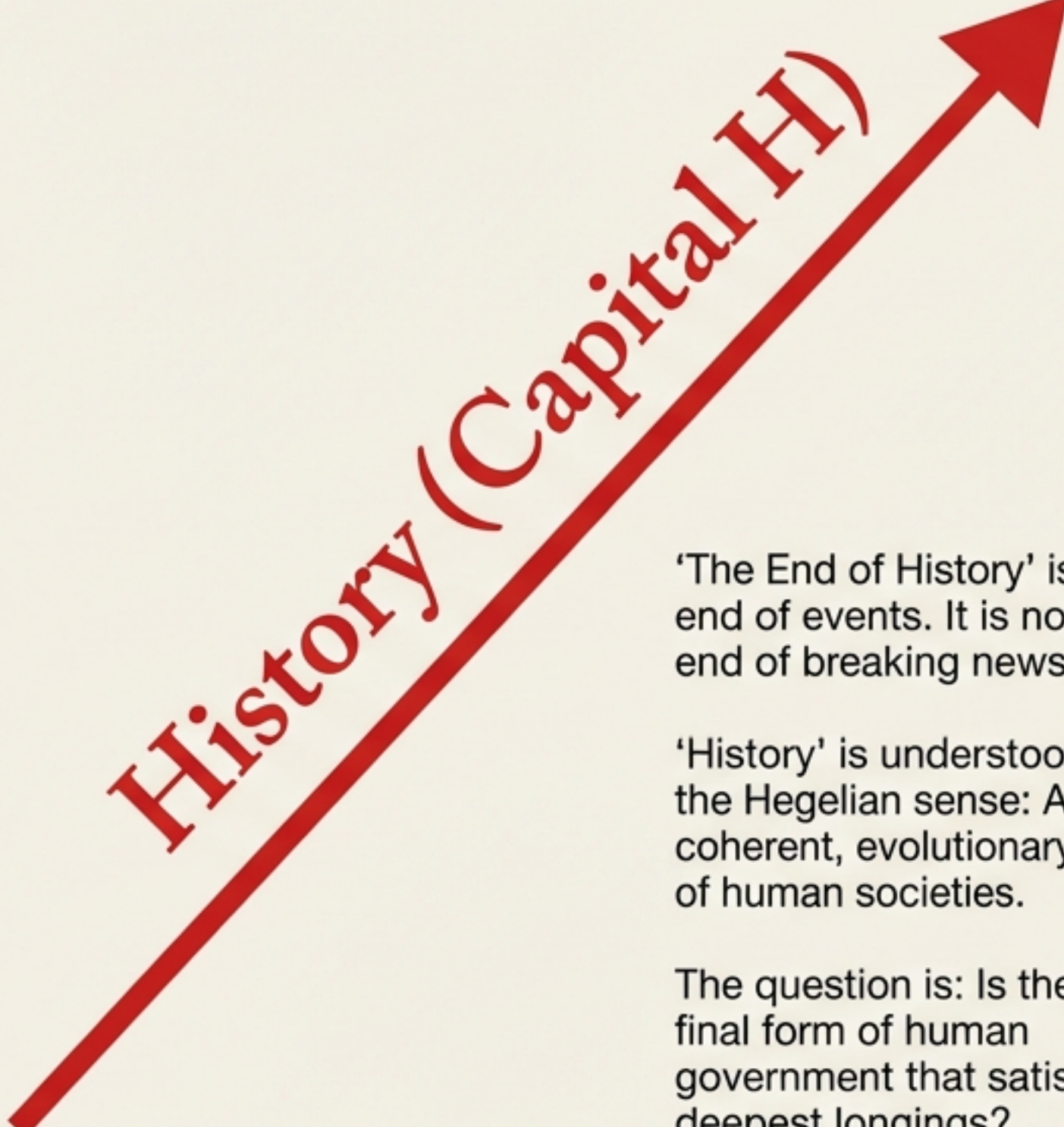


Is there a coherent direction to human evolution?

THE END OF HISTORY AND THE LAST MAN

**A DIALECTICAL JOURNEY THROUGH THE
EVOLUTION OF HUMAN GOVERNANCE**

BASED ON THE SEMINAL WORK BY FRANCIS FUKUYAMA

[illegible]

History (Capital H)

'The End of History' is the end of events. It is not the end of breaking news.

'History' is understood in the Hegelian sense: A coherent, evolutionary process of human societies.

The question is: Is the current form of human government that satisfies our deepest longings?

'History' is understood here in the Hegelian sense: A single, coherent, evolutionary process of human societies.

The question is: Is there a final form of human government that satisfies our deepest longings?

The 19th Century Illusion of Linear Progress.

19

1880: Robert Mackenzie describes history as a record of accumulating knowledge and increasing wisdom.

1910: Encyclopaedia Britannica defines "torture" as a subject of only historical interest.

1914: Norman Angell argues free trade has rendered war economically irrational.

Before the World Wars, Europe believed that science and democracy were leading inevitably to universal happiness.

The Catastrophe of the 20th Century



TOTALITARIANISM: A new type of state seeking to control every aspect of human life.

GENOCIDE: The elimination of entire classes of people by advanced, educated nations.

SCIENCE BETRAYED: Technology did not liberate; it created Hiroshima.

“The Meliorist Myth died in the trenches.”

The Collapse of Meaning



“Men wiser and more learned than I have discerned in history a plot, a rhythm, a predetermined pattern. These harmonies are concealed from me. I can see only one emergency following upon another as wave follows wave.”

— H. A. L. Fisher, 1934

The Intellectual Crisis: The conclusion that History is random.

The Illusion of Permanence

KISSINGER'S WARNING

The communist challenge
is unending. We must learn
to live with it forever.

REVEL'S FEAR

Democracy is a historical
accident, a brief parenthesis
closing before our eyes.

The Consensus of the 1970s: Totalitarianism was efficient and
invincible. Democracy was fragile and weak.

The Weakness of Strong States

The Surprise:
Strong states were
rotting from the inside.

1974:
PORTUGAL.

The Caetano
regime falls.

1974:
GREECE.

The Colonels
fall.

1975:
SPAIN.

Franco dies;
transition begins.

1980s:
ARGENTINA.

The Junta falls.



A Global Cascade



LATIN AMERICA

Peru (1980)
Argentina (1982)
Brazil (1984)
Chile (1990)
Nicaragua (1990)

EAST ASIA

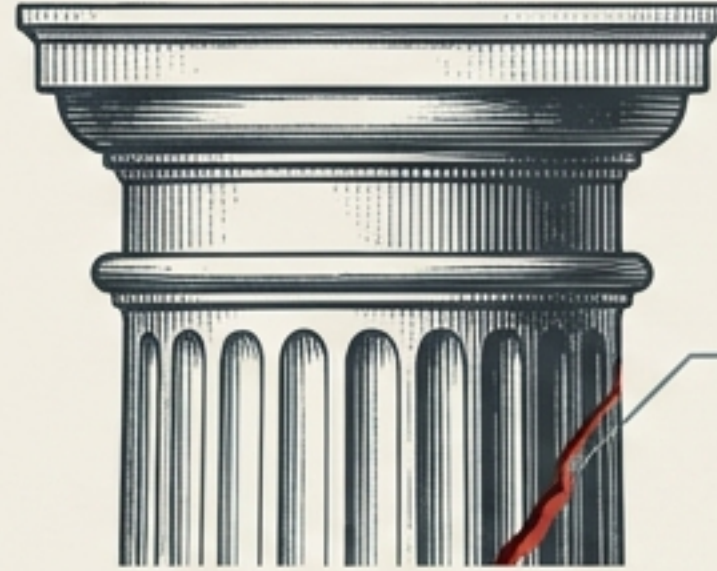
Philippines (1986)
South Korea (1987)
Taiwan (1988)

OTHER

South Africa (1990)
Eastern Europe (1990)

In **1970**, democracy was a rarity. By **1990**, it was the **only coherent political aspiration** spanning different cultures.

The Diagnosis: A Crisis of Legitimacy



The Void:
Communism and Fascism
failed to provide a coherent
social contract.

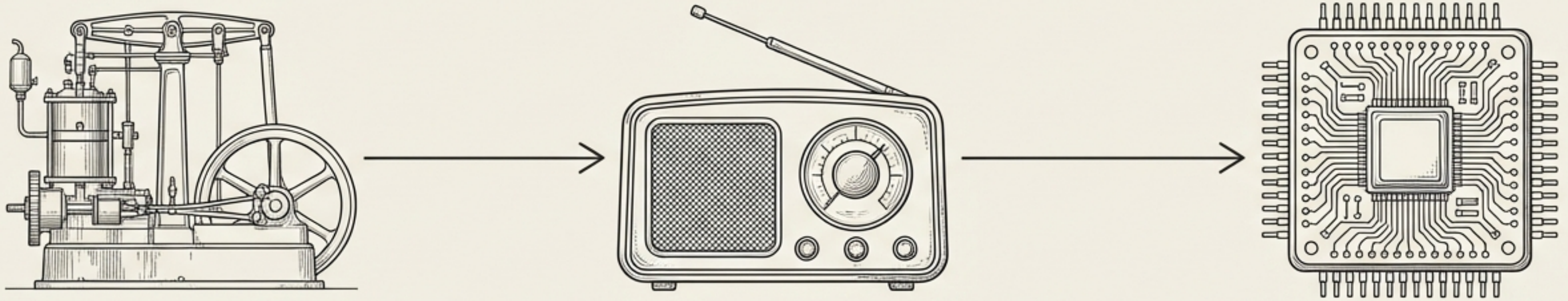
“They pretended to pay us,
and we pretended to work.”



The Elite Defection:
Army, Police, and Party lost
belief in the right to rule.

The Reality: Even a band of
robbers needs a principle of
justice to function.

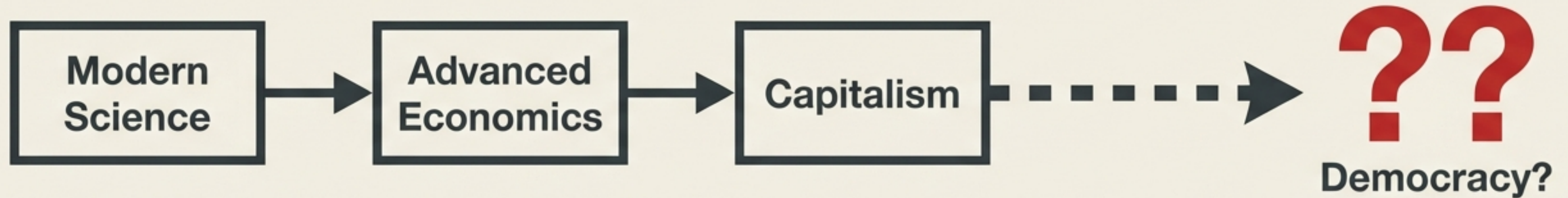
Engine 1: The Logic of Modern Science



CUMULATIVE **KNOWLEDGE** = **HOMOGENIZATION**

1. **Military Necessity:** Science mandates the modernization of defense.
2. **Economic Logic:** Technology creates a “universal horizon” of production.
3. **The Result:** To compete, all societies must eventually **urbanize**, **centralize**, and embrace rational markets (**Capitalism**).

The Missing Link



The logic of science leads us to the gates of the Promised Land (Capitalism), but it does not force us to enter.

The Anomalies (Authoritarian Capitalism)

- Meiji Japan
- Bismarckian Germany
- Modern Singapore

We are not just economic animals. If we were, we would be content in a prosperous dictatorship.

Engine 2: The Struggle for Recognition



Thymos: The part of the soul that demands recognition of one's worth.

Human beings desire more than food or shelter. We desire the desire of other men. We want to be recognized as dignified and free. It is this pride—not economic self-interest—that causes a man to **stand in front of a tank**.

Lordship and Bondage



Risks life for prestige.

**FLAWED
RECOGNITION**



Submits to fear of death.

History began with a battle to the death. This relationship is unstable: The Master is recognized only by a Slave (not an equal), and the Slave is not recognized at all.

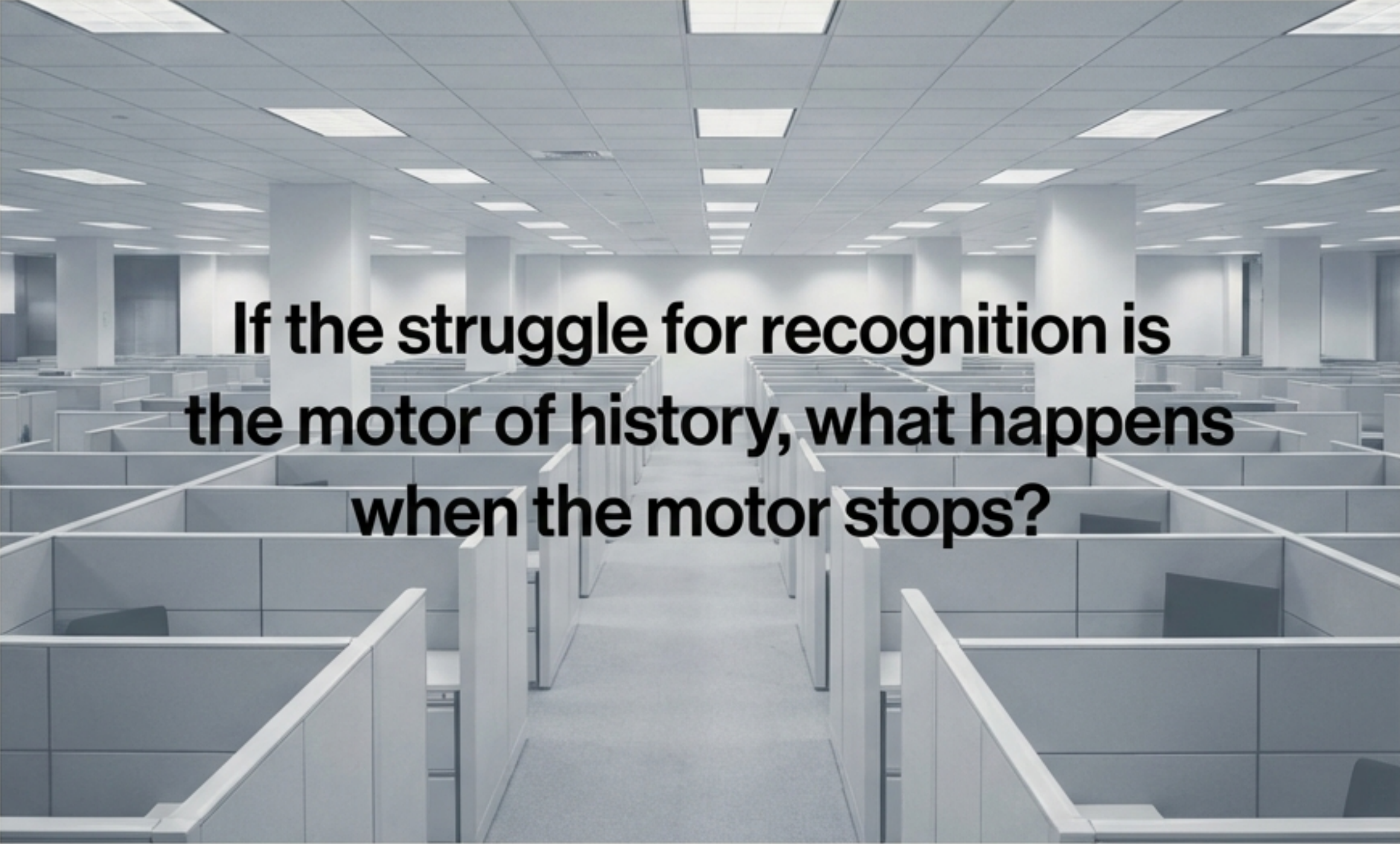
The Universal and Homogeneous State



The American and French Revolutions abolished the Master/Slave distinction.
The Master becomes a Citizen. The Slave becomes a Citizen.

In this specific sense, History—the search for a satisfying form of government—has ended.

The Paradox of Peace



**If the struggle for recognition is
the motor of history, what happens
when the motor stops?**

- **The Contentment:** Technical problem solving (environment, economics).
- **The Cost:** The loss of the arena for courage, daring, and sacrifice.

The Last Man

MEN WITHOUT CHESTS



The “Last Man” has given up prideful belief in his own superior worth in favor of comfortable self-preservation. He is clever at calculating self-interest, but unable to feel shame or great aspiration.

Immense Wars of the Spirit



**Will boredom with the
end of history serve to
restart history?**

They will struggle for the sake of struggle...
to avoid being 'men without chests'.